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THE WHITE HOUSE

WASHINGTON

MEMORANDUM OF TELEPHONE CONVERSATION

SUBJECT: Telcon with Francois Mitterrand, President of France on February 19, 1991

PARTICIPANTS: The President
President Francois Mitterrand
Adrian Basora, NSC Staff (Notetaker)
Eliza Burnham (Interpreter)

DATE, TIME February 19, 1991, 3:24 - 3:47 p.m.
PLACE: The Oval Office

The President: Francois, can you hear me OK? (U)

President Mitterrand: Yes, I hear you well. (U)

The President: I just wanted to touch base and compare notes on the Soviet initiative. (S)

President Mitterrand: I understand. I feel a great need to know your views on this. (S)

The President: I have already written to Gorbachev emphasizing the importance that there be a prompt and unconditional withdrawal from Kuwait. I said that I have problems with an unspecified length of time, and that 96 hours should suffice -- it only took the Iraqis 48 hours to go into Kuwait. After this, we have to keep the pressure on. (S)

President Mitterrand: Yes. (U)

The President: I stressed that Saddam Hussein would have to comply with all of the UN conditions. I am planning to send a second letter pinning down more details such as the need for an immediate exchange of POWs and the principle that there can be no cease fire until a credible withdrawal has begun. This will not be a problem for Gorbachev, but I question whether it will be acceptable to the Iraqis. (S)

We will not attack the departing forces. The POW exchange must occur within the first 24 hours. We have a lot of their prisoners, approximately 1,200. They have very few of ours, but they are very important to us. (S)

The Soviet initiative, in its totality, is not acceptable. But this does not mean that we have entirely closed it off. However,

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we cannot be drawn into negotiating the terms of the Iraqi withdrawal. The UN has established those terms. There can be no pause. It is military pressure that has brought us this far with Saddam Hussein, and this military pressure has to continue. (S)

I would very much like to know your views. (S)

President Mitterrand: My views are the following. First, we must have a very quick response from Saddam Hussein, that is, by tomorrow. Second, the reply must be very clear and unconditional. Third, any postponement makes for difficulties for our armed forces, vis-a-vis public opinion, or even within the coalition. You have seen the Italian and German reactions. (S)

The President: No, what are they? (U)

President Mitterrand: They have shown indiscriminate enthusiasm for the Soviet proposal. We have demanded that Saddam Hussein's response be rapid, clear, unconditional and fully in compliance with the UN resolutions. As long as he has not replied, we can continue the war, perhaps almost with increased force. (S)

The first hypothesis is that he imposes conditions for his withdrawal. In that case, the war would simply continue. The second hypothesis is that he agrees to depart without conditions. If so, that clearly changes the situation. We then must pose questions as to the modalities, such as the speed of withdrawal, the POW question, and the timeframe for his final pullout. You said four days. I would have said one week. (S)

The combatants will have to agree to these conditions. It is not up to the USSR to determine them. (S)

The President: Exactly. (U)

President Mitterrand: You are right that we must continue what we started, although we should not bomb withdrawing troops. But until they withdraw, the threat must continue to be felt by Saddam Hussein. This creates a special problem for Israel, however. (S)

Perhaps for the next few days we should pursue our discussions by means other than the telephone. I have no specific ideas, but let's think about the possible means of doing so. (S)

In conclusion, if Saddam Hussein accepts all these conditions, then we can't continue the war as we have until now. By this I mean our conditions, as we have outlined them, not just Soviet conditions. (S)

The President: What would be your prediction as to Saddam Hussein's reaction? You know him. (S)

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President Mitterrand: I don't know him, but if I look at the precedents, I think he will refuse. However, if Saddam Hussein is looking at Iraq's disastrous situation, he will find a way to withdraw. He will use some gimmick so as not to appear to be conceding. He will try to enhance his prestige by all available means. We must not allow him to do so. (S)

The President: I agree. (U)

President Mitterrand: This is the state of our thinking. I have worked on this with only a very small group of my advisers and we have not made the Gorbachev proposal public. We should consult fully, and we must act in concert. (S)

The President: I agree. We are not commenting on any of the specifics of the Soviet proposal as Gorbachev has requested. It is important to respect his request, although we must not let public opinion get out ahead of us, believing that peace is at hand and then having their hopes dashed. (S)

I have not yet talked to John Major although I have had a written message from him. You are the first person I have called. Have you spoken to John Major? I agree that we must stay in close touch. (S)

President Mitterrand: I spoke to John Major just 30 minutes ago. A rough summary of his thinking would be to say that he shares the same opinions that I do. (S)

The President: Do you think there are differences with the British? (S)

President Mitterrand: No, I said just the contrary. His position is the same as ours. (S)

The President: Good, that is very important. I have not talked to anyone yet. This is the first call I have made. (S)

President Mitterrand: Yes, yes. We need a response within 24 hours, otherwise we will be overwhelmed by public opinion getting out ahead of us and political statements will begin to be made by others, and the UN Security Council may be getting into the act. (S)

The President: Yes, that is true and it would not be productive at this stage. The Soviets have made a statement at the UN although I don't know the details of it. However, they have not revealed the details of their plan. (S)

The Soviets would clearly like a piece of the action. I see no problem in that, but they should not make the decisions. I don't think that they should carry the ball. They want to play a role, but they must not have too big a role and they cannot be the sole broker. The UN has a position, and the coalition has a position. I don't think we need the Soviets to negotiate for us. (S)

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President Mitterrand: The issue is very clear. As soon as Saddam Hussein's position is known, the role of the Soviets as a broker is over. We then take over. Those who are prosecuting the war should establish the conditions for his pullout, and that is we. But, of course, we should be very diplomatic with the Soviets. (S)

We will need to talk again very soon, since events are moving so swiftly. (S)

The President: Yes, but if Saddam Hussein comes back with new conditions, we must strive ahead with the war. (S)

President Mitterrand: I am absolutely in agreement. (S)

The President: I am asking Brent to see if we have anything further from Bessmertnykh with whom Baker was talking if you can hold on just for a minute. No, the call is just starting and it will take a while before we have any readout. Perhaps Brent can call Admiral Lanxade. (S)

President Mitterrand: Or Dumas can call Baker. (S)

The President: Yes. Thank you for the call and we will remain in close touch. (S)

President Mitterrand: Yes, indeed. Have a good day -- and this is the moment to say so. (S)

The President: Goodbye, Francois. (U)

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NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL

WASHINGTON, D.C. 20506

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February 20, 1991

FILE

ACTION

MEMORANDUM FOR BRENT SCOWCROFT

THROUGH: DAVID C. GOMPERT *RG*

FROM: ROBERT L. HUTCHINGS *RZH*

SUBJECT: Appointment Request for Janusz Ziolkowski,
Security Adviser to President Walesa of Poland

Ziolkowski (pronounced zhawl-KOF-ski, more or less) will be coming to advance Walesa's March 20 State Visit and has requested a meeting with you. We recommend that you spend a few minutes with him, after which David Gompert can continue with a more detailed discussion of how the Polish side sees the Walesa visit. A respected academic and associate of Foreign Minister Skubiszewski, Ziolkowski is brand new on the job, and it will be worth hearing how he assesses the Polish internal situation and Polish security concerns.

Ziolkowski is scheduled to meet with Larry Eagleburger at 3:00 p.m., February 26.

RECOMMENDATION

That you agree to meet with Ziolkowski for 15 minutes, February 25-27.

Approve _____ Disapprove _____

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PER NSC WAIVER, 1500 2021-02
By SS NARA, Date 9/30/25

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NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL
WASHINGTON, D.C. 20506

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PER NSC WAIVER, 1500 8021-02
By SS NARA, Date 9/30/15

February 20, 1991

INFORMATION

MEMORANDUM FOR BRENT SCOWCROFT

THROUGH: DAVID GOMPERT *NG*

FROM: NICHOLAS BURNS *NB*

SUBJECT: Your Meeting with Danish Foreign Minister Uffe
Ellemann-Jensen: Thursday, February 21; 2:15 p.m.

Ellemann-Jensen sees your 45-minute meeting as one of his key substantive encounters with U.S. officials during an otherwise ceremonial State Visit. He will be accompanied by Danish Ambassador Dyvig and two Foreign Ministry aides. Our Ambassador to Denmark, Keith Brown, and Nick will also participate.

Ellemann-Jensen has been the aggressive, driving force behind Denmark's decision to participate in the coalition (Denmark has contributed a corvette to the Gulf naval forces) and support the U.S. politically throughout the crisis. He has also personally assumed a leadership role among EC Foreign Ministers on the Baltics issue. Given his prominence on this issue, you should take the opportunity to solicit his views on EC plans for economic assistance to the USSR.

Ellemann-Jensen would like Denmark to assume a more activist role in international affairs but is hampered by the weakness of the governing coalition of Prime Minister Poul Schluter. The coalition has only a one vote majority and must secure Parliamentary approval on an issue-by-issue basis. Ellemann-Jensen is leader of the junior coalition Liberal party.

We suggest you cover the following issues in your meeting:

1) Gulf War

--Ellemann-Jensen will seek your views on the Soviet peace initiative and on our intentions in the days ahead.

--He will also be interested in our thoughts on post-war peacekeeping arrangements. The Nordics are interested in a UN peacekeeping role in the Gulf.

--You should thank him for Denmark's support and participation in the coalition, including economic aid to the front-line states and military aid to Turkey.

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2) Baltics

--Denmark led the EC debate on the Baltics and supported the decision to freeze EC economic aid to the Soviets (due to be reversed next week). The Danes condemned the use of force in very strong terms and have appealed to the Soviets for a return to peaceful and constructive negotiations.

--You might ask Ellemann-Jensen how the EC plans to conduct its assistance relationship with the Soviets and whether a deterioration in the Baltics would lead to another suspension of EC aid.

--Ellemann-Jensen may ask you what steps we would take if there is further use of force against the Baltic governments.

--The Danes are trying to increase their contacts with Baltic leaders but will not establish diplomatic relations with the Baltic states as Iceland is considering.

3) Uruguay Round

--We need commitments from the EC before March 1 on market access, export subsidies and internal supports.

4) European Architecture

--While the Danish government officially rejects an EC defense role, Ellemann-Jensen is personally sympathetic to one. He wants Denmark to join the WEU.

Attachments

Tab A	List of Participants
Tab B	Biography

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PARTICIPANTS

Foreign Minister Uffe Ellemann-Jensen

Ambassador Peter Dyvig

Otto Moller, Permanent Under Secretary, Foreign Ministry

Friis Peterson, Private Secretary to the Foreign Minister

Ambassador Keith Brown

Nick Burns

Withdrawal/Redaction Sheet

(George Bush Library)

Document No. and Type	Subject/Title of Document	Date	Restriction	Class.
03c. Report	Government Report (2 pp.)	2/11/91	(b)(1)	C

Collection:

Record Group: Bush Presidential Records
Office: National Security Council
Series: European / Eurasian Directorate Central Chron File
Subseries:
WHORM Cat.:
File Location: February 1991 [2]

Date Closed: 6/7/2011	OA/ID Number: 30513-006
FOIA/SYS Case #: 2011-0002-F	Appeal Case #:
Re-review Case #:	Appeal Disposition:
P-2/P-5 Review Case #:	Disposition Date:
AR Case #:	MR Case #:
AR Disposition:	MR Disposition:
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RESTRICTION CODES

Presidential Records Act - [44 U.S.C. 2204(a)]

P-1 National Security Classified Information [(a)(1) of the PRA]
P-2 Relating to the appointment to Federal office [(a)(2) of the PRA]
P-3 Release would violate a Federal statute [(a)(3) of the PRA]
P-4 Release would disclose trade secrets or confidential commercial or financial information [(a)(4) of the PRA]
P-5 Release would disclose confidential advice between the President and his advisors, or between such advisors [(a)(5) of the PRA]
P-6 Release would constitute a clearly unwarranted invasion of personal privacy [(a)(6) of the PRA]

C. Closed in accordance with restrictions contained in donor's deed of gift.

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(b)(7) Release would disclose information compiled for law enforcement purposes [(b)(7) of the FOIA]
(b)(8) Release would disclose information concerning the regulation of financial institutions [(b)(8) of the FOIA]
(b)(9) Release would disclose geological or geophysical information

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NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL
WASHINGTON, D.C. 20506

February 19, 1991

FILE

ACTION

MEMORANDUM FOR WILLIAM F. SITTMANN

FROM: NICHOLAS BURNS NB

SUBJECT: Telephone Conversations with President Turgut
Ozal of Turkey

At Tab I and Tab II are the memoranda of telephone conversations between the President and President Ozal on January 10, 1991.

RECOMMENDATION

That the Memoranda of Telephone Conversations at TABs I and II be filed for the record.

Approve _____

Disapprove _____

Attachments

Tab I Memorandum of First Telephone Conversation,
January 10, 1991

Tab II Memorandum of Second Telephone Conversation,
January 10, 1991

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White House Guidelines
E.O. 13526, SEC 3.4 (b), September 11, 2006
By MB NARA, Date 6/7/11

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